

Riverbend University

Student Handbook — Academic Year 2026–2027

1. Welcome to Riverbend University

This handbook is the official reference for all currently enrolled students at Riverbend University. It covers academic calendars, registration deadlines, campus facilities, codes of conduct, and the support services available to you throughout your program. Where this handbook and a program-specific prospectus disagree, the prospectus for your program takes precedence.

Riverbend University operates two main teaching blocks — the North Campus (Engineering, Computer Science, and Business) and the South Campus (Sciences, Humanities, and Health Studies) — connected by a free shuttle that runs every 15 minutes from 7:00 AM to 9:30 PM on weekdays.

2. Academic Calendar & Registration Deadlines

2.1 Semester Structure

The academic year is divided into two main semesters (Fall and Spring) and an optional Summer term. Fall semester runs from the last week of August to mid-December. Spring semester runs from mid-January to early May.

2.2 Elective Registration

Students must register for elective courses through the Student Portal each semester. **The last date to register for electives is the second Friday of the semester (Fall: first week of September; Spring: fourth week of January).** Registrations submitted after this date require a late-registration petition and a non-refundable late fee of \$25, approved by the Program Coordinator.

Electives with fewer than 8 enrolled students by the deadline may be cancelled, and affected students will be notified by email with alternative elective options within 3 working days.

2.3 Add/Drop Period

Students may add or drop a course without academic penalty during the first two weeks of each semester. Withdrawals after week 2 but before week 10 are recorded as 'W' on the transcript and do not affect GPA. Withdrawals after week 10 are recorded as 'WF' and are calculated as a failing grade.

3. Library Services

3.1 Opening Hours

Library / Facility	Weekdays	Saturday	Sunday
Main Library (North Campus)	7:30 AM – 11:00 PM	9:00 AM – 8:00 PM	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM
South Campus Reading Room	8:00 AM – 9:00 PM	9:00 AM – 5:00 PM	Closed
24-Hour Study Zone (Main Library, Level 1)	Open 24 hours	Open 24 hours	Open 24 hours

During the two weeks preceding final examinations, the Main Library extends its hours and remains open 24 hours a day, including weekends. Extended hours are announced on the library homepage at the start of each exam period.

3.2 Borrowing & Reservations

Undergraduate students may borrow up to 6 books for 14 days; postgraduate students may borrow up to 10 books for 21 days. Books can be reserved online and are held at the circulation desk for 48 hours. Overdue fines are \$0.50 per book per day, capped at \$15 per item.

4. Campus Facilities & Student Life

4.1 IT Helpdesk

The Student IT Helpdesk (Main Library, Ground Floor) handles Wi-Fi access, portal login issues, and device support. It is open Monday–Friday, 8:00 AM–6:00 PM. Common issues (password resets, portal access) can also be self-served via the 'IT Support' tile on the Student Portal.

4.2 Hostel & Accommodation

On-campus hostel accommodation is available for first-year and out-of-state students on a first-come, first-served basis. Applications open in the first week of July for the Fall semester and the first week of December for the Spring semester. Hostel fees are billed alongside tuition fees each semester.

4.3 Transport

The inter-campus shuttle is free for all students with a valid Student ID. City bus routes 12, 14, and 21 stop directly outside the North Campus main gate; a discounted student bus pass is available through Student Services.

4.4 Student Clubs & Societies

Riverbend University hosts over 40 recognised student clubs spanning technology, culture, sport, and community service. New clubs can be registered with Student Affairs at the start of each semester with a minimum of 10 founding members and a faculty advisor.

5. Code of Conduct

All students are expected to conduct themselves with honesty and respect for staff, peers, and campus property. Academic dishonesty, harassment, and damage to university property are handled under the

Student Disciplinary Policy, available in full on the Student Portal under Policies.

5.1 Academic Integrity

- Plagiarism, contract cheating, and unauthorised collaboration are treated as serious misconduct.
- A first proven offence typically results in a zero mark for the assessment and a formal warning.
- A second offence may result in suspension for one semester, subject to a disciplinary hearing.

6. Getting Help

Students who need support beyond what this handbook covers should contact the Campus Helpdesk (helpdesk@riverbend.edu, extension 2200) or visit the Student Services Centre on the ground floor of the North Campus Admin Block, open Monday–Friday 9:00 AM–5:00 PM.

Students experiencing stress, anxiety, or personal difficulty are strongly encouraged to reach out to the Wellbeing Centre or use the confidential 24/7 university counselling helpline printed on the back of every Student ID card.